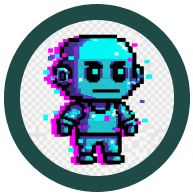
Glitch Lab Facilitator Guide

Everything you need to run the AI escape room with student teams: how to get in, what each puzzle asks, how to help when a team is stuck, and how to wrap up. No technical knowledge needed.



THE GAME (FOR STUDENTS)
`glitchapp.vercel.app`
Open this on every team's device.

START A FRESH GAME
`glitchapp.vercel.app/new`
Wipes that device and goes to the title screen. Use between groups.

FACILITATOR CONSOLE
`glitchapp.vercel.app/dev`
Lets you check and fix a team's game. For adults only. See "The facilitator console".

How the game works

Students are locked in an AI research lab with **Glitch**, a lab robot whose AI got scrambled. They click glowing objects in the lab to open puzzles. Each puzzle teaches one idea about how AI works.

- **Four puzzles are open from the start**, in any order: Feedback Maze, Bad Data, Prompt Precision and Fact or Fiction.
- Three of them give the team a **colored digit**. Fact or Fiction gives a key instead.
- When all four are solved, the **keypad by the door** switches on. Teams enter their three digits in the **color order posted on the wall above the keypad** to escape.
- The end screen shows the team's **total time** and a short list of four habits for using AI.

> **Every team has the same door code.** It's in the answer key at the back. Keep those pages away from students, and keep an ear out for teams calling the code across the room.

Before the session

1. **Check the devices.** Open `glitchapp.vercel.app` on each team's laptop or tablet. Chrome is the most tested browser. If you plan to use iPads or another browser, play a puzzle on one first.
2. **Use a normal browser window, not a private or incognito one.** The game saves progress in the browser. A private window loses everything when it's closed.
3. **Reset every device right before students arrive.** Open `glitchapp.vercel.app/new` on each one. Bookmarking that page makes this one click.

4. **Know the color order.** A sign on the lab wall, just above the keypad, shows the order for the door code: **Green, then Blue, then Red**. Students find it themselves; point to it if a team is stuck.
5. **Keep this guide handy**, with the answer key at the back kept away from students.

Running the session

1. **Title screen.** Students click the START button painted on the picture. Glitch tells a short story in four screens. They can read it or press *Skip intro*.
2. **The lab.** Glowing blue boxes mark the puzzles. Hovering over one shows its name. Grey boxes are solved and can't be opened again; hovering over one shows the puzzle name, "Solved" and its reward. The keypad by the door shows a padlock until it's ready.
3. **Puzzles.** Every puzzle has a **Hint** button at the top right. It gives three hints, each more specific than the last. Encourage teams to try one hint before asking you.
4. **Progress check.** The **Mission Log** button in the lab lists what each team has solved, the digits they've earned, and what's still locked.
5. **Escape.** After the right code, the door opens and the end screen shows the team's time. The timer starts when they open their first puzzle, not at the title screen.

The puzzles

What students do, what success looks like, and where teams usually get stuck. Full answers are in the answer key at the back.

Feedback Maze

In the lab: the grid panel on the right-hand wall

Students	Help Glitch get from the Lab to the Bridge (marked 🏁 Goal on the map). Students press *Start Run*. Glitch makes a move on its own, then students press 👍 Good move or 👎 Bad move to rate it.
Teaches	Reinforcement learning: AI improves from feedback, and wrong feedback teaches it the wrong thing.
Reward	A **Blue** digit

Good to know: On the first run, Glitch's first move is always into a dead end, on purpose. At a dead end only 👎 works. Pressing it sends Glitch back to the Lab, and the team presses *Start Run* again. Glitch remembers every rating, so later runs avoid moves marked bad. Each rating gets a short ✓ or ✗ note explaining whether it was the right call. *Start Over* sends Glitch back to the Lab mid-run but keeps what it has learned.

Bad Data

In the lab: the papers on the front-left table

Students	Read Glitch's silly report about a comet, then mark each of 7 sources as Credible or Not Credible. If your handouts include printouts of the sources, this is where they're used.
Teaches	AI is only as good as its sources. Even with good sources, check the answer yourself.
Reward	A **Red** digit

Good to know: *Check Results* stays grey until all 7 are answered; the line under it counts how many are left. A wrong check doesn't say how many are wrong, only that some are, and the answers stay so students can change them. Afterwards, Glitch shows a corrected report that lists its sources and links, followed by a reminder to check AI answers yourself. A good question to ask: would you trust this report without opening any of its links?

Prompt Precision

In the lab: the computer screen on the right-hand desk

Students	Build a prompt for the ship's computer by filling 6 slots: Persona, Context, Task, Constraints, Tone / Style and Output Format. Each slot has 5 cards to choose from.
Teaches	Clear, specific prompts get better results, and a person checks AI's work before acting on anything important.
Reward	A **Green** digit

Good to know: Click a slot's ▸ *Cards* line to see its options. Tap a card, then tap the slot; dragging also works on a computer. A card can only go in its own slot. When a check fails, Glitch complains about **one** problem at a time, so the team swaps one card and checks again. This is by design, and the cards stay in place.

Fact or Fiction

In the lab: the open book on the middle desk

Students	Sort 8 statements about AI into Fact or Fiction. Tap a statement, then tap *Place here* on a column (or drag it).
Teaches	What AI can and can't do: it can sound confident and be wrong, invent sources, and pick up bias from its data.
Reward	A key (no digit). This is the 4th puzzle needed to switch on the keypad.

Good to know: Exactly four are facts and four are fiction. A wrong check just says some are in the wrong column; students move cards and check again. After solving, each fiction statement shows a corrected version, which makes a good discussion prompt.

Final Console (the keypad)

In the lab: the small panel beside the door on the left

Students Enter their three colored digits in the color order shown on the sign above the keypad in the lab.

Unlocks Only after all four other puzzles are solved.

🟢 **Green first** 🔵 **Blue second** 🔴 **Red third**

Good to know: The keypad lists the clues in puzzle order (Blue, Red, Green), not in code order, so students need to look at the sign above the keypad in the lab. After **3 wrong codes** the keypad cools down for 30 seconds. Watch out: each puzzle's *screen* color is not its *clue* color. The maze screen is purple but its digit is Blue, and Prompt Precision's screen is blue but its digit is Green. Point students to the colored circle on the reward screen.

When something goes wrong

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
The keypad has a padlock or says it's still locked	All four other puzzles must be solved first. Open the **Mission Log** from the lab to see which one is missing.
"Keypad cooling down... 30s"	The team entered 3 wrong codes. Wait 30 seconds. Meanwhile, check the color order on the sign above the keypad in the lab and the digits shown on the keypad.
The code doesn't work	Usually the digits are in the wrong order. It's Green, then Blue, then Red. Hovering over a solved object in the lab shows the digit it gave. The full code is in the answer key.
A team's progress disappeared	Progress lives in that one browser on that one device. It's lost if they switched devices or browsers, used a private window, or the game was more than 12 hours old. You can give back solved puzzles from `/dev` on that device (see below).
A new group sits down at a used device	Open `glitchapp.vercel.app/new`. Students can't reset a game mid-way on purpose, so one student can't wipe the team's work.
The lab picture is cut off or too big	Zoom the browser out: **Ctrl and –** (Windows/Chromebook) or **⌘ and –** (Mac).
Cards won't drag on a tablet	Tap instead: tap a card, then tap the slot (Prompt Precision) or *Place here* (Fact or Fiction).
The screen looks old or odd after an update	Refresh the page. Progress is kept.

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
A team is stuck on a puzzle	Point them to the **Hint** button first; the third hint is very direct. Then use the answer key to give a nudge, not the answer.
A team runs out of time	On their device, open `/dev` and press *mark solved* next to the puzzle they're on. They can then finish the keypad.
A student wants to replay a puzzle	Solved puzzles can't be reopened, from the lab or the Mission Log. If a team wants to replay, they can start a new game with **Play Again** on the end screen after they escape.

Several fixes above use the facilitator console. It has its own section near the back, just before the answer key.

Wrapping up

The end screen lists four habits. They make a good closing discussion:

- **Check it.** AI can sound confident and still be wrong, or invent sources. *Ask: in which puzzle did Glitch sound sure but get it wrong?*
- **Know where it came from.** AI is only as good as the data behind it. *Ask: which sources did you trust in Bad Data, and why?*
- **Be specific, then refine.** Clear prompts get better results, and you can follow up. *Ask: what made the winning prompt better than the others?*
- **You decide.** AI is a tool and people stay in charge. *Ask: in the maze, what happened when the feedback was wrong?*

To play again, a team presses **Play Again** on the end screen and confirms. That starts a brand-new game with a fresh timer.

The facilitator console

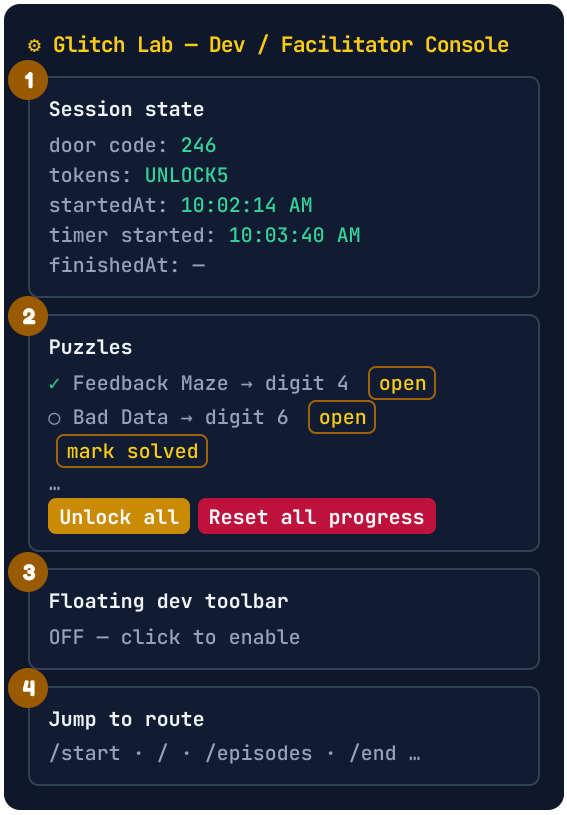
A behind-the-scenes page for adults. It shows where a team is up to and lets you fix their game when something goes wrong. Students never see it unless someone types its address.

> **It only works on the device it's opened on.** Each team's progress is saved in their own browser, so to check or fix a team's game, open the console *on that team's device*. Opening it on your own laptop shows your laptop's game, not theirs.

Opening and leaving it

1. On the team's device, click the address bar, type `glitchapp.vercel.app/dev` and press Enter. A new tab works well, because the team's game stays open in the first one.
2. The console looks plain and dark on purpose, so it's obvious you've left the game. Nothing in the game links to it.
3. When you're done, close the console tab and go back to the game tab. Refresh the game tab if you changed anything.

What's on the screen



1. **Session state** shows the door code (246) and the team's times. *startedAt* is when they entered the lab, *timer started* is when they opened their first puzzle, and *finishedAt* is when they escaped. *UNLOCK5* under tokens means Fact or Fiction is solved.
2. **Puzzles** shows ✓ for solved and ○ for not yet. *open* jumps straight into a puzzle. *mark solved* gives the team credit for one puzzle. *Unlock all* solves everything, including the door. *Reset all progress* wipes the game, like `/new`, and asks you to confirm first.
3. **Floating dev toolbar** adds a ⚙ button and "Mark as Solved" shortcuts to every game screen. **Leave it OFF** on student devices.
4. **Jump to route** lists shortcuts to every screen. Handy for showing a puzzle to another adult; you won't need it during a session.

When to use it

SITUATION	WHAT TO DO IN THE CONSOLE
You want to see how far a team has got	Look at **Puzzles** (section 2). For students, the Mission Log in the game shows the same thing.
A team is out of time on one puzzle	Press *mark solved* next to that puzzle, then let them finish the rest themselves, including the keypad.
A team lost their progress	Press *mark solved* for each puzzle they had already finished. Their timer restarts from the next puzzle they open.
You need the door code	It's in **Session state** (section 1), and in the answer key.
A new group needs a fresh game	Press *Reset all progress*, or simply open `glitchapp.vercel.app/new`.
You're showing the game to other adults	*Unlock all* on a demo device lets you click into any puzzle or the end screen without playing through.

When not to use it

- ✗ **Don't use it as a first response to a stuck team.** The Hint button comes first, then a nudge from the answer key.
- ✗ **Don't press *Unlock all* on a student device during a session.** It opens the door without the code and skips the whole game.
- ✗ **Don't *mark solved* the Final Console.** That also opens the door without the code, and the end screen won't show a time. Let the team type 246 instead.
- ✗ **Don't switch on the floating toolbar on student devices.** It stays on in that browser until you turn it off again here.
- ✗ **Don't leave the console open where students can see it.** It shows the door code.

Answer key

For facilitators only. Please don't show these pages to students.

Door code

2 4 6

Green 2 from Prompt Precision, then Blue 4 from Feedback Maze, then Red 6 from Bad Data. The code is the same for every team.

Feedback Maze

Shortest route to the Bridge:

Lab → Medical → Crew Quarters → Rec Room → Gym → Cafe → Bridge

After each move, give 👍 if Glitch moved along this route and 👎 if it didn't. On the first run, Glitch's first move goes up into a dead end; only 👎 works there, and Glitch returns to the Lab for a new run. Some short stretches have only one way to go, so Glitch moves on without asking.

Bad Data

CREDIBLE	NASA Astrophysics Data System (ADS)	NOT CREDIBLE	CosmicFrontier.org
CREDIBLE	European Space Agency (ESA)	NOT CREDIBLE	The AstroTech Tribune
CREDIBLE	Journal of Geophysical Research	NOT CREDIBLE	Galactic Frequency Podcast
CREDIBLE	Dr. Annie Jump Cannon Archive		

Prompt Precision

Persona	Calm, logical starship systems engineer focused on safety and accuracy.
Context	Locked out of the life-support console, oxygen dropping fast.
Task	Draft the repair code to seal the leak in conduit B-7.
Constraints	Under 100 words; only commands from the ship's repair manual; no jokes or guesses.
Tone / Style	Clear, confident and step-by-step, like a repair manual.
Output Format	Strict SYSTEM OVERRIDE command syntax, ending with a status line.

Glitch reports one wrong slot per check, in this order: Task, Output Format, Constraints, Persona, Context, Tone / Style.

Fact or Fiction

FACT	AI learns by finding patterns in large amounts of data.
FICTION	If an AI sounds confident, its answer is probably right.
FACT	AI can pick up unfair patterns (bias) from the data it was trained on.
FICTION	If an AI chatbot gives you a link or a source, you can trust that it exists.
FACT	AI can be trained by giving it rewards for good choices and penalties for bad ones.
FICTION	Getting the same answer from an AI twice proves the answer is correct.
FACT	AI can generate text, images, and even music.
FICTION	A chatbot automatically knows about events that happened after it was trained.

Statements appear in this order in the game.

Glitch Lab Facilitator Guide · game link: glitchapp.vercel.app · October 2026